

BONING Strips of whalebone, or later flexible steel or plastic, added to garments, especially bodices and corsets, to help them stay up and support shapes; see also *Basque*, *Corset*.

16TH CENTURY ▷: SEE PP.432–3

BONNET Originally a soft head covering, but later a women's hat with a brim only at the front.

MEDIEVAL ▷: SEE PP.178, 193

BOOT-CUT A style of trousers with a straight-leg fit from waist to knee and a slight flare below the knee.

1990s ▷: SEE P.451

BOSOM FRIENDS *Woollen* or fur pads fitted to the bosom for warmth and as bust enhancers.

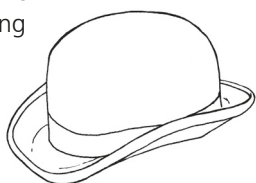
LATE 18TH–EARLY 19TH CENTURY

BOUCLÉ A term for a fabric knitted or woven using looped or rough-textured *yarn*, giving a knobby appearance.

LATE 19TH CENTURY ▷

BOWLER A hard *felt* hat with a rounded crown and a narrow brim rolled up at the sides, worn for horse riding and later as smart headgear.

1850s ▷: SEE PP.227, 265



BOX COAT (a) Heavy, caped overcoat typically worn by coachmen; (b) loose-fitting coat popular in the 1930s and 40s, with a boxy shape and squared, padded shoulders.

LATE 18TH CENTURY ▷

BOXER SHORTS Loose-fitting cotton shorts with an elasticated waistband, worn by men as underpants; based on the shorts worn by professional boxers, which allow free movement.

1940s ▷

BOX PLEAT A flat *pleat* created by two folds facing towards each other and pressed flat.

LATE 19TH CENTURY ▷: SEE PP.145, 452

BRAID Strands of ribbon or cord interwoven to form a narrow strip, often used as an edging for garments.

MEDIEVAL ▷: SEE PP.176–7

BRAIES Baggy medieval underwear worn under *tunics*; stocking-like *hose* were attached to the braies; as *tunics* became shorter and slimmer, the braies became shorter and more fitted.

MEDIEVAL: SEE P.72

BRASSIÈRE Women's undergarment worn to support the bust; many types have underwiring to give extra support and shape; usually abbreviated to bra.

EARLY 20TH CENTURY ▷: SEE P.277

BREASTPLATE A piece of plate armour worn over the front of the torso to protect the chest.

MEDIEVAL ▷: SEE PP.69, 92–3

BREECHES In medieval times, the upper part of men's long *hose*; later, men's fitted trousers ending at the knee.

14TH CENTURY ▷: SEE PP.88–9, 154

BRETON SHIRT Originally worn by fishermen in Brittany, a long-sleeved garment like a *T-shirt*, with a *boat neck*, and traditionally with navy and white stripes.

MID-19TH CENTURY ▷

BRIAL Spanish *tunic* made of expensive fabric such as *silk brocade* or *silk* with gold thread; laced down one side.

12TH–14TH CENTURY

BRISTOL DIAMONDS A type of rock crystal found near Bristol in south-west England and used as imitation diamonds in jewellery.

17TH–19TH CENTURY

BROADCLOTH Fine *woollen* cloth with a *twill weave* and a smooth *face*; an economic staple in England and Flanders in medieval times.

MEDIEVAL ▷

BROCADE Luxury fabric woven with *silk* and often including silver

or gold threads, with an extra *weft* added to create a raised pattern.

MEDIEVAL ▷: SEE P.141

BRODERIE ANGLAISE *Whitework embroidery* featuring floral motifs created from pierced holes bound with *satin stitch*; often used to adorn underwear.

17TH CENTURY ▷

BROGUES Durable leather shoes with punched-leather decoration.

LATE 19TH CENTURY ▷: SEE P.301

BROTHEL CREEPERS *Suede* shoes with *crepe rubber* soles, first worn by soldiers in World War II, and then adopted as part of *Teddy-boy style*; they gained the name “brothel creepers” from the soldiers' habit of wearing them to visit nightclubs.

1940s ▷: SEE P.341

BUCKLED WIG

A man's wig with horizontal rolls of hair above or around the ears.

18TH CENTURY: SEE PP.150–51



BUCKRAM Fine *cotton* or *linen* often stiffened, and used in the 19th century for making women's hats.

13TH–19TH CENTURY

BUCKSKIN Leather made from deer hide, used for gloves and at one time for *breeches*; also known as *deerskin*.

15TH CENTURY ▷

BUFF COAT A hard-wearing military coat made from buffalo or ox hide; later adopted by civilians.

16TH–17TH CENTURY

BUGLE BEADS Small tubular beads, which can be smooth or faceted, used to adorn women's clothes.

19TH CENTURY ▷

BUNDHOSEN *Breeches* that finish just below the knee, with a lacing or a buckle closure at the hem; traditional in German-speaking countries.

MEDIEVAL ▷



Shoshone woman, Idaho, USA

Dress of the American Indian Shoshone people is frequently made of animal skin that is ornately embellished with natural motifs using beading and *embroidery*.



“Mountie” in ceremonial garb, Canada

This man wears the uniform of the Royal Canadian Mounted Police, who are distinguished by their scarlet Red Serge belted *tunic* with gold buttons.